Employer Nomination Scheme visa (subclass 186)

Direct Entry stream

This visa lets skilled workers nominated by an employer live and work in Australia permanently.

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For Applicants For Sponsors

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With this visa, you can

- stay in Australia indefinitely
- work and study in Australia
- enrol in Australia's public health care scheme, Medicare *(http://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/medicare)*
- sponsor eligible relatives to come to Australia
- travel to and from Australia for 5 years
- apply for Australian citizenship *(/citizenship/what-does-it-mean)*, if eligible.

Ask a question

Newly arrived residents may have to wait before they can access certain Australian Government payments and benefits *(https://www.humanservices.gov.au/individuals/enablers/newly-arrived-residents-waiting-period)*.

How long you can stay

This is a permanent visa – it lets you stay in Australia indefinitely.

You become a permanent resident on the day we grant the visa.

Your permanent residency for citizenship purposes starts:

- on the day we grant the visa if you are in Australia
- on the day you enter Australia on this visa if you are outside Australia

Include family

You can:

- include family members in your application when you apply
- add family members to your application after you apply but before we decide on your visa.

For this visa, your family members are:

- your partner
- your dependent child or stepchild
- your partner's dependent child or stepchild
- the dependent child or stepchild of your or your partner's dependent child or stepchild.

You can also include a subclass 457 visa or subclass 482 visa holder if we granted them that visa as a member of your family. To meet this requirement, they must hold the eligible visa and must be included in your application when you apply.

Family members who apply for the visa with you must meet our health and character requirements.

Family members who do not apply for the visa with you may also have to meet the requirements.

Cost

The visa costs AUD6,140.00 for the main applicant. Concession apply in limited circumstances.

There is also a charge for each family member who applies for the visa with you.

To see what your visa will cost use the Visa pricing estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator)*. The estimator does not consider the second instalment or other costs.

Second instalment

You must pay an extra charge called a second instalment for any family member aged 18 years or older who:

- applies for the visa with you, and

- has less than Functional English.

The second instalment for family members who apply for the visa with you is AUD4,890.00.

If you need to pay the second instalment, we will send you an invoice after you have met all other requirements for the visa.

Other costs

You might also have to pay other costs for:

- health checks
- police certificates
- biometrics.

Cost concession for eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste visa applicants

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application.

We will charge eligible applicants the lower visa application cost during the application process in ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*. We will recognise eligible applicants by the valid passport from the specified countries used in the application when they apply.

Family members are also eligible for the lower visa cost. We base this on the passport of the primary applicant (or visa holder who satisfies the primary visa criteria).

The primary applicant must hold a valid passport issued by one of the following countries:

- Federated States of Micronesia
- Fiji
- Kiribati
- Nauru
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Republic of the Marshall Islands
- Samoa
- Solomon Islands
- Timor-Leste
- Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu.

Apply from

You can be in or outside Australia when you apply for the visa, but not in immigration clearance.

If you are applying in Australia, you must hold a:

- substantive visa or

- Bridging visa A *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-a-010)*, Bridging visa B *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-b-020)* or Bridging visa C *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-c-030)*.

You can be in or outside Australia when we decide on your application.

Processing times

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

Your application can take longer to process if:

- you do not fill it in correctly
- you do not include all the documents we need or we need more information from you
- it takes us time to verify your information

Applications lodged with all necessary supporting documents ('complete applications') can generally be processed more quickly.

Your obligations

You and your family members must obey all Australian laws.

We expect that you will work for your nominating employer for at least 2 years if your visa is granted.

You agree to begin your employment within 6 months of:

- entry to Australia if you were granted the visa outside Australia
- the visa grant date if you were granted the visa in Australia

Travel

From the date we grant this visa, you can travel to and from Australia for up to 5 years.

After that period, you will need a Resident Return (RRV) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)* visa to re-enter Australia as a permanent resident.

If you leave Australia after the expiry date of your travel facility, without being granted another permanent visa with a valid travel facility, for example a Resident Return (RRV) *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/resident-return-visa-155-157)*, you might not be able to return to Australia as a permanent resident.

To see when your travel condition ends, use VEVO *(https://online.immi.gov.au/evo/firstParty?actionType=query)*.

Visa label

Australian visas are digital. You will not get a label in your passport.

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